

# Enforcing Mandatory Fields Using UI Policies and Migrating Changes with Update Sets

ServiceNow Project Documentation

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[UI Policy](#) | [UI Actions](#) | [Update Sets](#)

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# 1. Problem Statement & Objective

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## Problem Statement

In this project, we address the issue by implementing a UI Policy that makes the Priority field mandatory when the State of an incident is set to "In Progress". We capture and migrate this configuration using Update Sets, enabling seamless deployment across different ServiceNow instances.

## Objective

Demonstrate exporting and importing the Update Set, ensuring configurations can be easily transferred between environments.

## Skills Required

- UI Policy
- UI Actions
- Update Sets

## 2. Milestone 1 – Update Sets

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### 2.1 Activity 1: Create Update Set

**Steps:**

1. Open ServiceNow.
2. Click on **All** >> search for "Update Sets".
3. Select **Local Update Sets**.
4. Click **New** to create a new Update Set.
5. Enter Name as "UI policy".
6. Set State to "In Progress".
7. Click **Submit/Update**.
8. Set this Update Set as the Current Update Set by clicking "Set as Current".

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ServiceNow Developer

UI policy (Update Set) (ServiceNow)

https://dev311564.service-now.com/now-ui/policies/updatesets/targets?sys\_id=ad5b7531-93e2-424b-ba2b-25222b5f07b2&sysparm\_context=ui\_policy

ServiceNow

All Favorites History Admin

Update Set - UI policy

Search

Update

Description

Update

Related Links

Merge With Another Update Set

Scan Update Set

Customer Updates List

Update Set Logs

Create Update Sets

Install History

Created

Search

Actions on selected rows...

Update set - UI policy

| Created             | Type             | View | Target name        | Updated by | Remove update set | Action           |
|---------------------|------------------|------|--------------------|------------|-------------------|------------------|
| 2025-02-05 21:28:39 | UI Policy        |      | Mandatory Priority | admin      | (empty)           | INSERT_OR_UPDATE |
| 2025-02-05 21:36:45 | UI Policy Action |      | priority           | admin      | (empty)           | INSERT_OR_UPDATE |

1 to 2 of 2

SPC

Search

11:27

04-08-2025



## 3. Milestone 2 – UI Policy

### 3.1 Activity 1: Create UI Policy

#### Steps:

1. Navigate to **All** >> search for "UI Policies".
2. Click **New**.
3. In the **Table** field, type "inc" and select "Incident [incident]" from the dropdown.
4. Enter **Short Description** as "Mandatory Priority".
5. Set **Order** to 100.
6. Ensure **Active** checkbox is checked.
7. Set **Application** to Global.
8. Enable both **Global** and **On Load** checkboxes.
9. Click **Submit**.

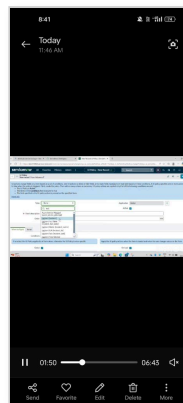


Figure 2 – Selecting Incident table in UI Policy

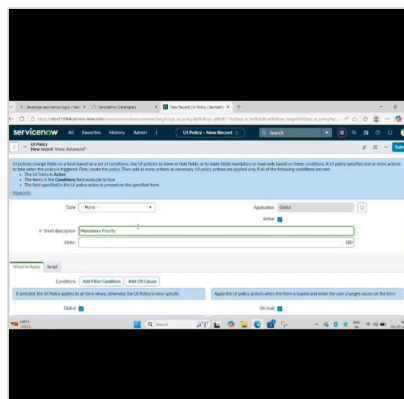


Figure 3 – UI Policy "Mandatory Priority" form

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow 'New record' form for a Policy. The form is titled 'New record' and includes a 'Short description' field that is filled with 'New task to monitor'. The form also includes fields for Number, Category, Subcategory, Service, Service offering, Configuration item, Class, State, Impact, Urgency, Assignment group, and Assigned to. The 'Short description' field is highlighted with a red border, indicating it is the focus of the figure.

Figure 4 – UI Policy New Record with Short Description filled



## 3. Milestone 2 – UI Policy (Cont.)

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### 3.2 Activity 2: Add Condition

**Steps:**

1. In the UI Policy form, click on the "When to Apply" tab.
2. Click "Add Filter Condition".
3. Set the filter: **Field** = State | **Operator** = is | **Value** = In Progress.
4. This ensures the UI Policy only triggers when the Incident State is "In Progress".
5. Click **Submit** to save.

## 3. Milestone 2 – UI Policy (Cont.)

### 3.3 Activity 3: Add UI Policy Action

#### Steps:

1. Scroll to the "UI Policy Actions" related list in the UI Policy form.
2. Click **New** to add a UI Policy Action.
3. The UI policy field auto-populates with "Mandatory Priority".
4. Set **Field Name** to "Priority".
5. Set **Mandatory** to "True".
6. Set **Visible** to "True".
7. Set **Read Only** to "True".
8. Click **Submit**.

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow web interface for creating a new UI Policy Action. The browser address bar shows the URL: [https://dev315964.service-now.com/form/new?ui\\_policy\\_action.do%3Fsys\\_id%3D11628bys\\_a\\_8d%3Dtrue%2Bsys\\_a\\_related\\_to%3Dtr...](https://dev315964.service-now.com/form/new?ui_policy_action.do%3Fsys_id%3D11628bys_a_8d%3Dtrue%2Bsys_a_related_to%3Dtr...). The page title is "UI Policy Action - New Record". The form contains the following fields:

- UI policy:** Mandatory Priority
- Table:** Incident [Incident]
- \* Field name:** Priority
- Application:** Global
- Mandatory:** True
- Visible:** True
- Read only:** True
- Clear the field value:** ☐

A "Submit" button is located at the bottom left of the form. The Windows taskbar at the bottom shows the date and time as 04-25-2026 11:04.

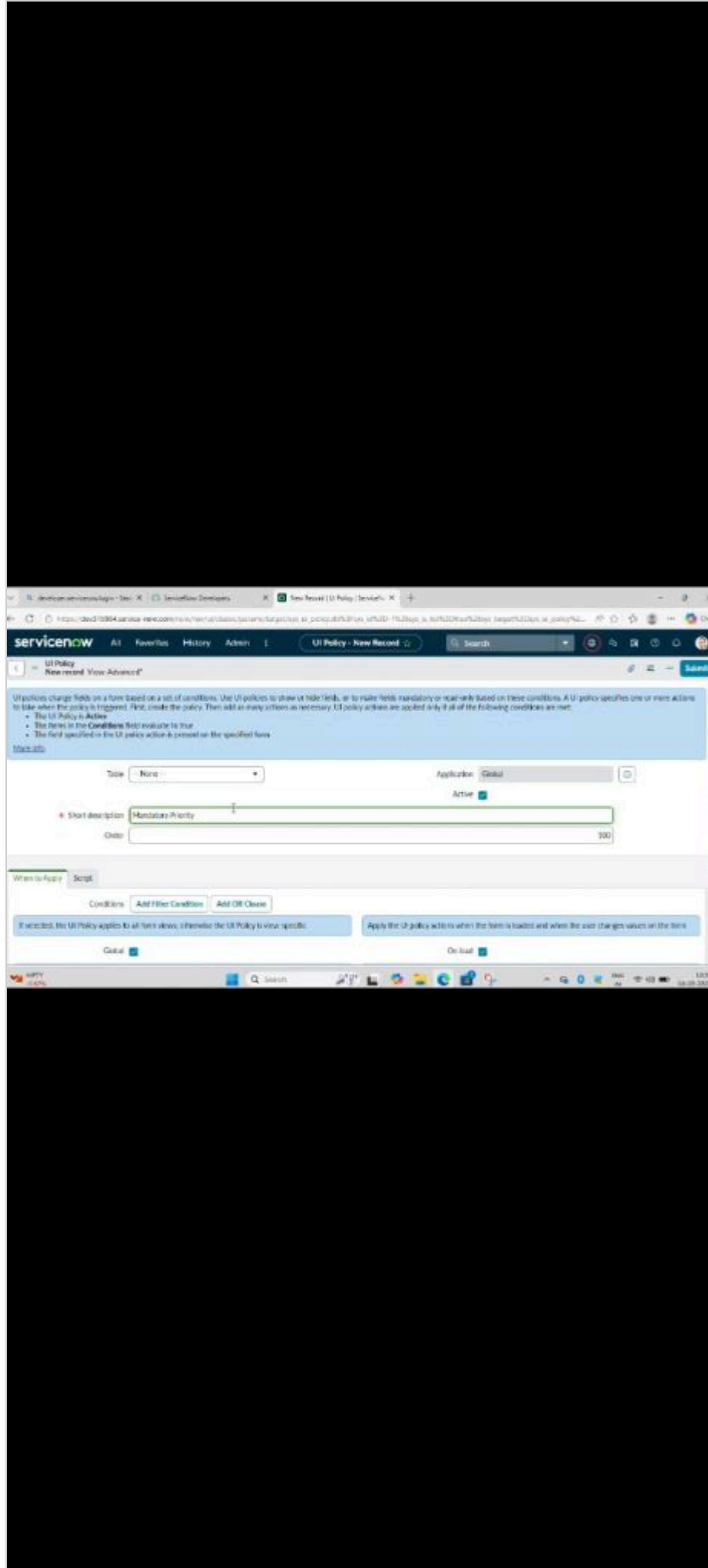


## 4. Milestone 3 – Testing

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### Steps:

1. Navigate to the Incident module from the left navigation.
2. Click **New** to create a new Incident.
3. Fill **Caller** field (e.g., Adela Cervantsz).
4. Set **Category** to "Inquiry / Help".
5. Set **State** to "In Progress".
6. Set **Impact** to "1 - High" and **Urgency** to "1 - High".
7. Enter **Short Description**: "new task is created".
8. Click **Submit** WITHOUT filling in the Priority field.
9. **Observe**: A red warning banner appears — "The following mandatory fields are not filled in: Short description / Priority".
10. The Priority field is highlighted in red/orange confirming the UI Policy is active.





## 5. Milestone 4 – Export & Import Update Set

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### 5.1 Export Update Set

1. Navigate to Local Update Sets and open the "UI policy" Update Set.
2. Click the Customer Updates tab and verify 2 records:
  - UI Policy: Mandatory Priority (INSERT\_OR\_UPDATE)
  - UI Policy Action: priority (INSERT\_OR\_UPDATE)
3. Change State from "In Progress" to "Complete" and click **Update**.
4. Right-click the form header or use the context/hamburger menu.
5. Select **Export > Export to XML**.
6. The XML file downloads automatically to your local machine.

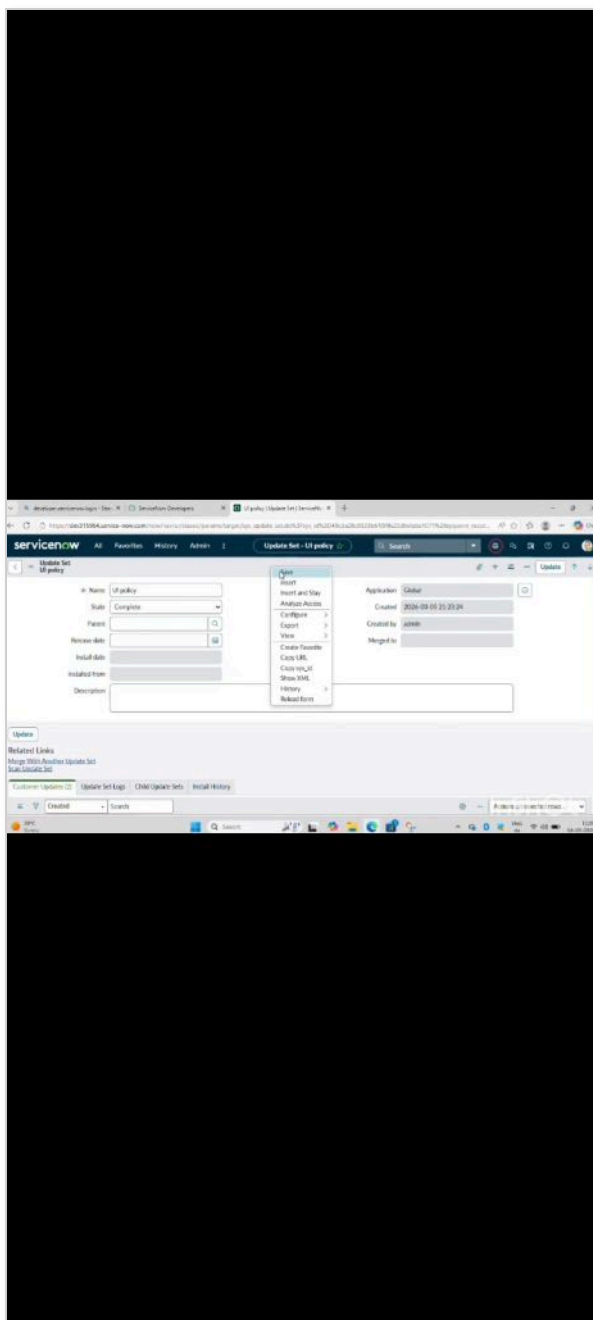


Figure 7 – Exporting Update Set to XML

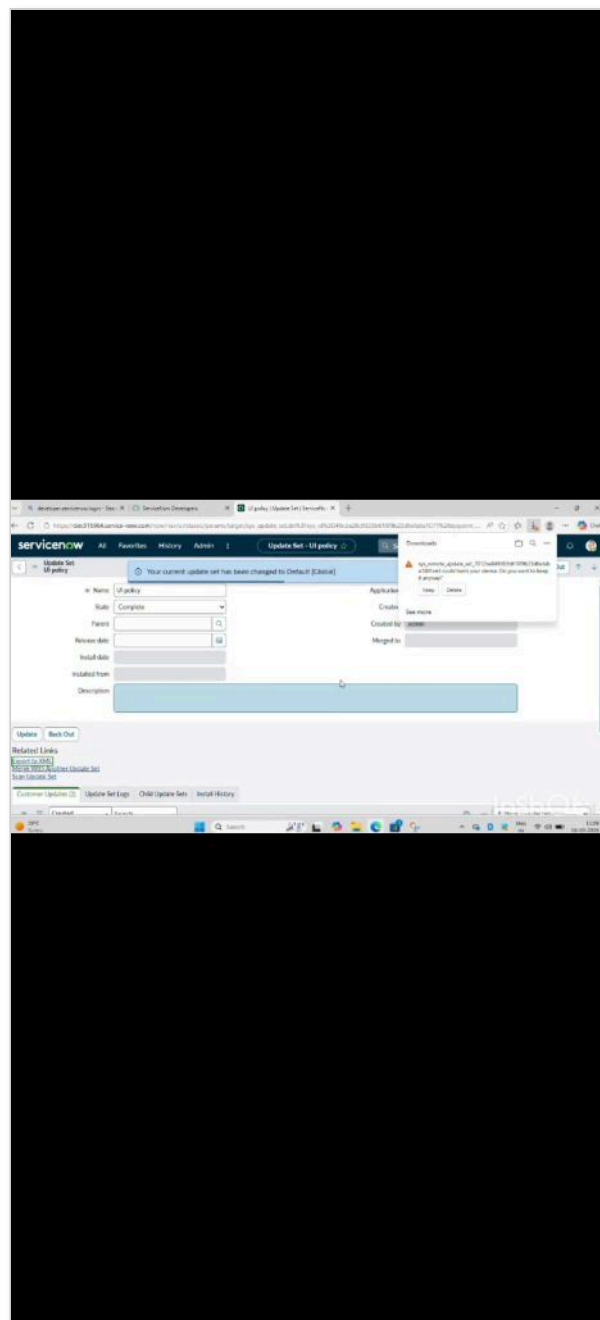


Figure 8 – Update Set XML downloaded

## 5.2 Import Update Set

1. Log into the target ServiceNow instance.
2. Navigate to **All** >> search for "Retrieved Update Sets".
3. Click **Import XML**.
4. On the Import XML page: Click Choose File, select the XML file exported earlier.
5. Click **Upload**.
6. The Update Set now appears in Retrieved Update Sets list.
7. Open the retrieved Update Set and click **Preview Update Set**.
8. Review the preview for conflicts.
9. Click **Commit Update Set**.



10. System confirms: "Update set committed - Succeeded in 0 Seconds."

11. Click **Close**.

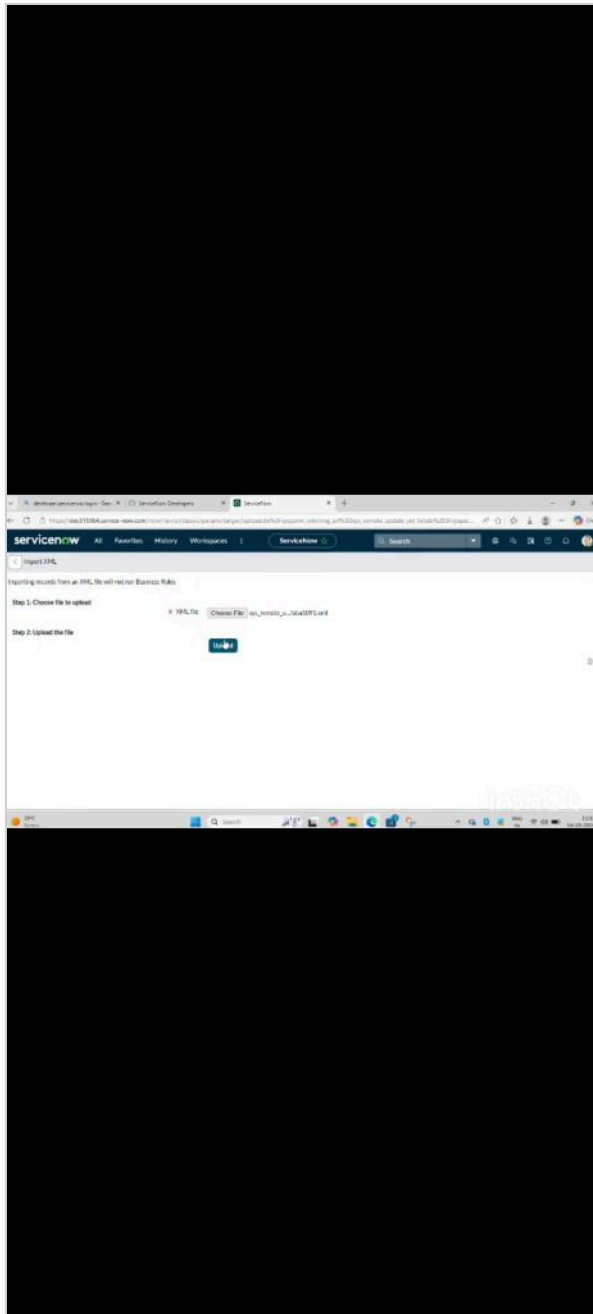


Figure 9 – Import XML page

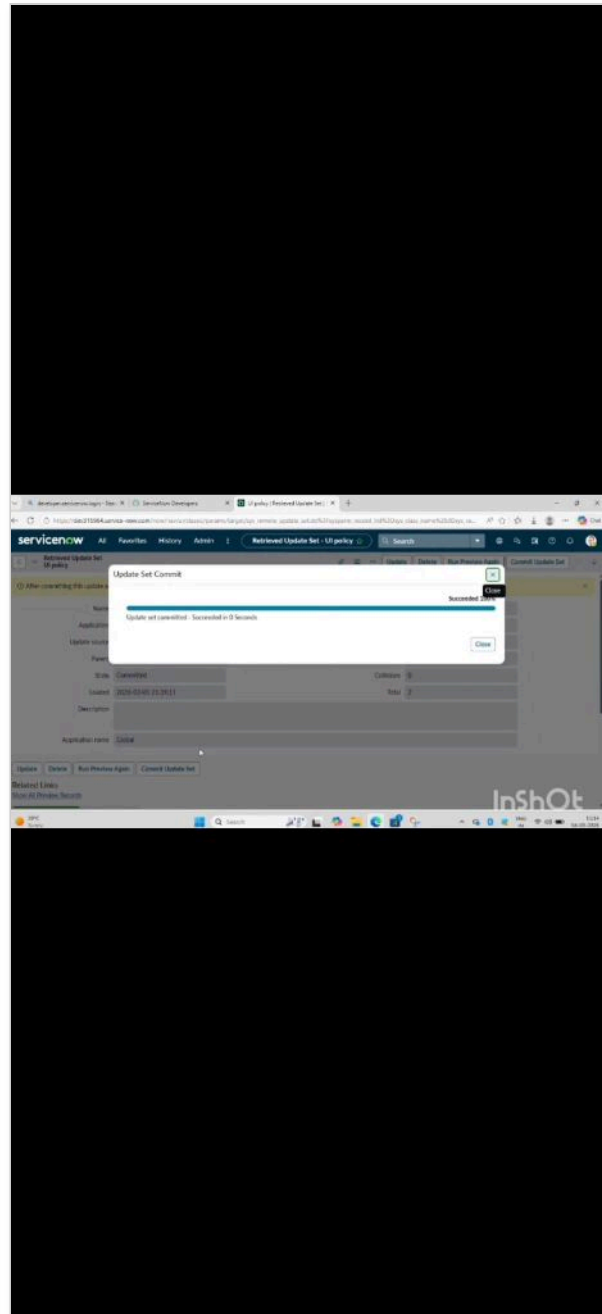


Figure 10 – Update Set committed successfully

## 6. Conclusion

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In this project, we successfully:

- Created a UI Policy named "Mandatory Priority" targeting the Incident table.
- Added a condition so the policy triggers only when State = "In Progress".
- Added a UI Policy Action making the Priority field Mandatory, Visible, and Read-Only.
- Tested the UI Policy by creating an Incident with State = "In Progress" and verified the mandatory field warning appears when Priority is not filled.
- Captured all configurations in an Update Set named "UI policy".
- Exported the Update Set as an XML file from the source instance.
- Imported and committed the Update Set in a target ServiceNow instance, confirming seamless migration.

This project demonstrates how ServiceNow's UI Policies enforce data quality and how Update Sets enable reliable configuration migration across environments — key skills for any ServiceNow Administrator or Developer.